



City Commission Agenda Report

City of Kalamazoo

Date: **3/6/2023**

Item: **G.7.**

TO: Mayor Anderson, Vice Mayor Cooney, and City Commissioners

FROM: James K. Ritsema, ICMA-CM, City Manager
Reviewed by: James J. Baker, PE, Public Services Director and City Engineer
Prepared by: Sohil Manjiyani, Sr. Civil Engineer City Engineer - Wastewater

DATE: March 6, 2023

SUBJECT: Professional Services Agreement with Abonmarche Consultants, Inc. for 2023-2024 Ransom Street Improvements Construction Administration (Bid Ref # 92549-001.0.1)

RECOMMENDATION:

It is recommended that the City Commission approve a Professional Services Agreement with Abonmarche Consultants, Inc. for the Ransom Street Utility Upgrade & Right of Way Improvements Construction Administration services in the amount of \$849,910.00.

BACKGROUND:

On May 16, 2022, the City Commission approved the Clean Water State Revolving Fund (CWSRF) project plan submittal via adoption of resolution 22-26. The City of Kalamazoo CWSRF project on Ransom Street was competitively approved and ranked for funding by the Michigan Department of Environment Great Lakes and Energy (EGLE) and assigned a critical path milestone schedule.

The existing Ransom Street Sanitary Sewer Interceptor, Walbridge to Westnedge, is under capacity for the existing and future flow contribution tributary areas. This Project will replace and upsize the remaining entirety of the original interceptor with one which meets current engineering and regulatory standards. The existing water transmission main will be upgraded to increase the reliability of the water utility. The Project will also identify and replace lead water services which may exist within the construction limits. The right-of-way corridor will also receive planned improvements.

The existing Ransom Street corridor is a mix of City Local and City Major streets including sections of brick pavement. The planned intent of this Project is to extend the City Major Street designation from Burdick Street to Westnedge Ave following the guidance of Imagine

Kalamazoo 2025 and the Northside Neighborhood Plan, 2018.

The planning and design phase of this project involved public outreach and stakeholder engagement to ensure the project will meet the needs of the Northside Neighborhood and Northside Cultural Business District. Within this public process, the neighborhood stakeholders requested options for streetscape amenities and improvements.

The base bid for this project includes hardscape treatments reutilizing the historic brick pavers, new seat walls, improved street lighting, restoration of parkway lawns, and planting a diverse selection of new trees as approved by the City of Kalamazoo Tree Committee.

Stakeholder engagement reflected a desire for additional aesthetic improvements in the form of additional landscape plantings with ornamental grasses, shrubs, and flowering perennials. These additional aesthetic landscaping elements are not included within the Water, Wastewater, Major Streets or Local Streets budget, these items have been designated and included in the plans as an alternate bid item. This allows the City of Kalamazoo the option to award this scope of work or defer to future construction opportunities as budget resources are identified.

This project has been divided into two phases in accordance with construction and tie in constraints with the sanitary interceptor and water transmission main. Phase I lies within the limits from Walbridge to N. Rose St., phase II lies within the limits from N. Rose to N. Westnedge Ave. This project is scheduled to begin construction after April 17, 2023, with phase I to be completed by November 1, 2023. Phase II is scheduled to begin on March 1, 2024, with all work completed by November 1, 2024.

On February 20, 2023 the City Commission approved a \$12,287,470.60 construction contract with Kamminga & Roodvoets, Inc. for the base bid construction items for this project.

A separate contract currently estimated at \$504,250.00 will be presented for consideration to recommend awarding the street lighting improvements to Consumers Energy in the future. Construction of the street lighting is scheduled in a lagging timeframe within the project phasing.

A portion of the original interceptor, watermain, and right-of-way corridor was previously upgraded and improved from Gull Street to Walbridge under the River's Edge Roundabout Project. This Project continues both the utility infrastructure and right-of-way corridor upgrades and improvements.

Abonmarche Consultants, Inc. is a pre-qualified engineering firm with experience and specialization in the Ransom Street project. Abonmarche has worked with the City on all previous phases of this project to include Project Plan submittal, planning and stakeholder engagement and complete design engineering.

Stakeholder engagement identified pedestrian access within the Ransom Street area to food

stores, grocery, medication and access to daily needs as highly critical. The Construction Administration team will have daily onsite interaction with the Contractor(s) performing the work and citizens, business owners and stakeholders who must access and use Ransom Street to ensure access and construction progress are communicated and that concerns are responded to. The Construction Administration team will also serve as the owner's representative to ensure that daily construction progress, activities and performance meets all specifications including critical path items.

STRATEGIC VISION ALIGNMENT:

Strategic Goal Impact:



Good Governance- Ensuring the City organization has the capacity and resources to effectively implement the community's Strategic Vision in a way that is sustainable over the long term.



Safe Community- Creating a safe environment for living, working, and playing



Environmental Responsibility - A green and healthy City.



Economic Vitality - A supportive infrastructure for growing businesses and stabilizing the local economy for the benefit of all.



Connected City - A City networked for walking, biking, riding, and driving



Inviting Public Places - Vibrant streets, exceptional parks, and welcoming activities.



Complete Neighborhoods - residential areas that support the full range of people's daily needs

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT:

Appropriate Depth of Engagement

Inform (one-way conversation) – no feasible alternatives available due to legal/regulatory restrictions, standards and best practices, or resource limitations; the community will be made aware of the project.

A Design Team comprised of Community Planning and Economic Development and Public Services Departmental staff collaborated to create select a Firm which is believed to provide the best value to the Project.

Collaborate (two-way conversation) - the community will have a chance to shape the project by providing feedback.

During the Construction Phase, meetings will be held to update the Neighborhood and Community Stakeholders of the design as well as afford said Stakeholders opportunities to provide suggestions and feedback for incorporation consideration into the final construction.

FISCAL IMPACT:

The funds required for this contract are \$849,910.00. The funding available and estimated costs are detailed below. We are requesting the approval of this purchase using the funds below.

Description	Account	Project #	Dollar Amount
Streets CIP		MST0100223	\$275,317.55
Water Resources - CIP		WAT0500364	\$217,929.13
Wastewater - CIP		WWR0200065	\$356,663.32